Royal Devon and Exeter NHS
NHS Foundation Trust

Clinical Guideline for:
Use of Propofol for Sedation on ICU

SUMMARY

Propofol is a general anaesthetic agent which is used for the induction of anaesthesia in healthy patients, for sedation by infusion in critically ill patients on intensive care, and occasionally as incremental boluses to facilitate interventions such as NGT placement on patients on the ICU.
It is profoundly cardiovascularly depressing, and should therefore only be used with EXTREME caution in patients who are shocked, and in patients who need intubation to facilitate respiratory support. It must only be used by practitioners trained in airway management and providing respiratory support.

KEY POINTS

Propofol must NOT be used for sedation of children under the age of 16 years on ICU. It should also be avoided in patients with a peanut or soya bean allergy.

Required Monitoring :

ECG monitoring
Blood pressure monitoring – ideally invasive
Continuous respiration monitoring due to apnoeas

Propofol is presented in ampoules as below:
1% Propofol 20mls
1% Propofol – 50mls
2% Propofol – 50mls

Dosage and administration :

1% propofol contains 10mg/ml
2% propofol contains 20mg/ml

Maximum dosage of propofol by infusion is 4mg/kg/hr – so, for example, for an 80kg man, the maximum dosage of propofol would be 32ml/hr of 1%, and 16ml/hr of 2%

Infuse propofol until desired level of sedation is reached. Only under exceptional circumstances should patients be sedated with propofol alone – it is usual to co-administer an opiate such as alfentanil or morphine – see separate sedation policy.

Aim for sedation score of +1 to -1 unless specifically requested by the ICU consultant.

Can be given centrally or peripherally.

In accordance with established guidelines for other lipid emulsions, a single infusion of propofol must not exceed 12 hours. At the end of the procedure or at 12 hours, whichever is the sooner, both the reservoir of propofol and the infusion line must be discarded and replaced as appropriate

Propofol is given neat and should not be diluted before administration.

Propofol infusion is incompatible with :

Metoprolol
Amikacin
Amphotericin
Gentamicin
Calcium Chloride
Tobramycin
Ciprofloxacin

Side effects: hypotension, bradycardia, apnoea, fat overload, convulsions + myoclonic movements.

PUBLICATION DETAILS

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